

MAKING A CLAIM

Your claim: what happens next

We are here when it matters most. A claim can feel like a lot, so this guide explains what happens next, who may be involved, and the simple things you can do to help us assess your claim quickly and fairly. Most claims move smoothly once we have the information we need, and we will guide you through the process and explain what we need at each stage.

Who may be involved in your claim

Your insurer

Your insurer is the underwriter of your policy and is named in your policy documents. MyInsurer handles your claim on your insurer's behalf under delegated authority. Our role is to assess your claim fairly and consistently in line with the terms, conditions, limits and exclusions of your policy.

Your claims handler

Your claims handler will be your main point of contact. They will guide you through the process, explain what information is needed, keep you updated and help move your claim towards a decision.

Specialists and surveyors

Depending on your claim, we may appoint a specialist or surveyor to inspect the damage, confirm the cause, make recommendations, or prepare a schedule of repairs. Where needed, specialist drying, cleaning or restoration may also be arranged. The work required and the time it takes will depend on the type and extent of the damage.

Loss adjuster

For larger or more complex claims, or where a site visit would help, we may appoint a loss adjuster. They may inspect the property, assess the damage, review the cause and discuss the appropriate next steps with you.

How your claim works

Every claim is different, but most claims move through three main stages.

1 Review and validation

We gather the information needed to assess your claim. This may include photographs, videos, repair estimates, proof of ownership, reports from contractors, a surveyor visit, a loss adjuster visit or a video call. We may also check that the conditions of your policy have been met. Asking for information is a normal part of assessing a claim and does not mean a decision has been made.

2 The decision

Once we have the information we need, we will review your claim against the terms, conditions, limits and exclusions of your policy. We will then explain whether the claim is covered, partly covered, or not covered.

3 Settlement or repairs

If your claim is covered, we will explain the settlement options available. Depending on the claim and your policy terms, this may include a cash settlement, approved repairs, replacement, or another appropriate solution.

A cash settlement is often the quickest and most practical option, as it allows you to arrange the work yourself using a contractor you trust. Where this is appropriate, we will agree a fair amount with you based on the insured damage, the policy terms and reasonable repair or replacement costs.

What you can do to help your claim

A few simple steps can help us assess your claim quickly and avoid delays.

Show us what has happened. Please take clear photographs or a short video of the damage and the affected area before anything is repaired, moved or disposed of, where safe to do so.

Prevent further damage. As soon as it is safe to do so, you must take all reasonable steps to prevent further loss or damage to your property. This is a condition of your policy. This could include stopping a leak, turning off the water supply, arranging emergency repairs, boarding up a broken window, or making your home secure. If reasonable steps are not taken, your insurer may not cover additional damage or costs that could reasonably have been avoided, and this may affect your claim.

Keep damaged items. Please keep damaged items where possible, as they may need to be inspected. If you cannot keep them, please take clear photographs first and tell us before disposing of anything connected to your claim.

Keep receipts and invoices. Please keep receipts for any emergency work, materials, temporary repairs or other costs connected with the claim. These will be reviewed as part of the claim assessment and must be reasonable and related to the insured damage.

Repair estimates and quotes. We encourage you to obtain repair or replacement quotes from your preferred local contractors. This can help progress your claim more quickly and gives you the opportunity to choose a contractor you trust. Before we agree settlement, we may validate quotes with the contractor, review the scope of works, compare costs against local market rates and approved supplier rates, and obtain independent estimates where appropriate. This helps ensure any settlement is fair, reasonable and in line with the policy.

Do not authorise permanent repairs too early. Emergency repairs to prevent further damage are fine, but please do not authorise permanent repairs or replacement works until we have confirmed what is covered and agreed the next steps. If permanent work is completed before we have had the opportunity to assess the damage, this may affect what can be paid.

Be open and accurate. Please make sure the information you give us is complete and accurate. This helps your claim move smoothly and helps us make a fair decision. We may check information, invoices, quotes, reports and other evidence as part of the normal claim process.

How settlement may be worked out

If your claim is covered, we will explain clearly how any settlement has been calculated.

Your settlement will be based on the insured damage, your policy terms, your policy limits, your excess and any relevant deductions or adjustments. Insurance is designed to put you back in the position you were in before the loss. It does not cover upgrades, improvements, wear and tear, maintenance, pre-existing damage, or costs that are not covered by your policy.

Where an older or worn item is replaced with a new item, an allowance may sometimes apply if the replacement would leave you better off than before. If this applies, we will explain it before settlement is agreed.

Your excess is the amount you contribute towards a claim. It is shown in your policy documents and is usually applied once your claim has been agreed.

If all or part of your claim is not covered

Sometimes a policy may not cover all of the damage claimed. If that happens, we will explain the reason clearly, show you the relevant part of your policy and answer any questions you have.

Common reasons can include wear and tear, maintenance issues, policy exclusions, damage that happened gradually, pre-existing damage, or costs that fall outside the cover provided by your policy.

Supporting you and your family

If you or a family member needs extra support during the claim, please tell us. For example, we can agree a preferred contact method, allow more time to provide information, speak with someone you authorise, or explain things in a different way.

If something is not right

We want to get your claim right. If you are unhappy with anything, please tell your claims handler first so we can try to put it right quickly. If you would like to make a formal complaint, contact us on 0344 225 0942 or at claims@myinsurer.co.uk, and we will explain the complaints process.

Contact us

Your claims team is here to help.

Phone: 0344 225 0942, Monday to Friday, 9:00am to 5:30pm.

Email: claims@myinsurer.co.uk (please quote your claim reference in the subject line).

Online: sign in at claims.myinsurer.co.uk to track your claim, send us information and message your handler.